

HOUSE BILL 2378

By Doggett

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15,
Chapter 2, relative to a day of special observance
to celebrate Brigadier General Casimir Pulaski.

WHEREAS, Brigadier General Casimir Pulaski, born in Warsaw, Poland, in 1745, was a renowned military commander and a dedicated champion of liberty who fought courageously against tyranny in both his homeland and the United States; and

WHEREAS, following a meeting with Benjamin Franklin in Paris, Casimir Pulaski arrived in Philadelphia in 1777, offering his services to the Continental Army with the famous declaration to General George Washington: "I came here, where freedom is being defended, to serve it, and to live or die for it"; and

WHEREAS, General Pulaski demonstrated extraordinary valor at the Battle of Brandywine, where he led a daring charge that is credited with saving the life of General George Washington and preventing a rout of the American forces; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of General Pulaski's military prowess and leadership, the Continental Congress appointed him a Brigadier General and authorized the formation of an independent corps of cavalry and light infantry, known as the Pulaski Legion, earning him the enduring title of "Father of the American Cavalry"; and

WHEREAS, on October 9, 1779, while leading a cavalry charge against British forces during the Siege of Savannah, General Pulaski was mortally wounded, and subsequently passed away on October 11, 1779, making the ultimate sacrifice for the cause of American independence; and

WHEREAS, the memory of General Pulaski is woven into the history and geography of this State, most notably through the City of Pulaski, the county seat of Giles County, Tennessee, which was named in his honor to memorialize his heroism; and

WHEREAS, October 11 is federally recognized as General Pulaski Memorial Day, and it is fitting that the State of Tennessee formally sets aside this day to honor his legacy, celebrate the contributions of Polish-Americans to our State, and remember the price paid for our nation's freedom; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the recurring anniversary of this day be commemorated with suitable patriotic and public exercises in observing and commemorating the death of this great American hero of the Revolutionary War; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15, Chapter 2, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

October 11 of each year is to be observed as "General Pulaski Memorial Day."

This day is not a legal holiday as defined in § 15-1-101.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.